

NovaCart

Payment Policy

Document Type: Customer & Support Knowledge Base Policy

Version: 1.0

Status: Active for Autonomous Customer Support Copilot Demo

Policy Area	Payment processing and payment-related support
Applies To	NovaCart customers placing orders through supported channels
Supported Region	India
Support Email	support@novacart.example
Support Hours	Monday–Sunday, 9:00 AM–9:00 PM IST

1. Purpose

This Payment Policy explains how payments are handled on NovaCart, what customers can expect during checkout, how payment failures are handled, and what information may be required when a payment-related issue is reported.

The policy is intended to provide consistent guidance to customers and to the NovaCart customer-support system. Specific refund processing rules are maintained separately in the Refund Policy.

2. Supported Payment Methods

NovaCart supports the following payment methods where available for the customer's order and location:

- Credit cards and debit cards.
- UPI-based payments.
- Net banking.
- Selected digital wallets.
- Cash on Delivery (COD), where the product, delivery location, and order meet the applicable eligibility conditions.

The payment methods displayed at checkout are the methods currently available for that particular order. Availability may vary based on product category, order value, delivery location, or operational restrictions.

3. Payment at Checkout

Customers must select an available payment method during checkout and provide the information requested by the selected payment provider.

For online payments, the customer may be redirected to or interact with a payment service interface. NovaCart considers an online payment successful only after receiving the required confirmation from the payment process.

Customers should not repeatedly attempt payment if their bank or payment provider shows that a transaction is already being processed. Repeated attempts may create multiple pending transactions, which can require additional verification.

4. Order Confirmation

A successful payment does not by itself guarantee that an order has been confirmed. An order is considered confirmed only when NovaCart successfully records the order and provides an order confirmation.

Customers should check their order status after completing payment. The order confirmation may be shown in the customer account and/or sent through the communication channel associated with the account.

5. Payment Successful but Order Not Confirmed

If money has been deducted but the order is not confirmed, the customer should not immediately make another payment.

The customer should retain:

- The transaction or payment reference ID.
- The approximate transaction date and time.
- The amount charged.
- The payment method used.
- Any available payment confirmation or receipt.

Support may use these details to investigate whether the payment was received, is still pending, or requires reconciliation. If the payment cannot be matched to a confirmed order, the case may be escalated for further investigation and handled according to the applicable refund process.

6. Payment Failed

A payment may fail because of insufficient funds, bank or payment-provider issues, authentication failure, expired or blocked payment credentials, network problems, or other processing errors.

When a payment fails and no amount has been deducted, the customer may retry using an available payment method after checking the information entered at checkout.

If an amount was deducted despite the payment being reported as failed, the customer should retain the transaction reference and contact NovaCart support rather than repeatedly retrying the same transaction.

7. Pending Payments

A payment may remain pending when confirmation from the bank or payment provider has not yet reached NovaCart.

Customers should allow the payment status to update before making another payment for the same order. If the payment remains pending beyond the expected processing period or the order is not confirmed, the customer should contact support with the transaction details.

A pending transaction is not automatically treated as a completed NovaCart order.

8. Duplicate Payment

If a customer believes that the same order was charged more than once, the customer should provide the order number and relevant transaction references.

Support should verify whether:

- More than one payment was successfully captured.
- One transaction is only pending.
- One transaction was reversed or automatically released.
- Multiple payment attempts were associated with the same order.

Any confirmed duplicate payment should be handled through the applicable reconciliation and refund process.

9. Cash on Delivery

Cash on Delivery is available only for eligible orders and supported delivery locations. Availability may also depend on product, seller, order value, and operational conditions.

For COD orders, the customer does not need to make an online payment at checkout unless the checkout page specifically requires another payment arrangement. Customers should follow the delivery instructions provided with the order.

COD availability may change and should be determined from the options shown during checkout.

10. Payment Security

Customers should never share their card PIN, UPI PIN, account password, one-time password (OTP), or other confidential authentication credentials with NovaCart support.

NovaCart support representatives should not request confidential payment credentials through chat or email. Customers should use only the official NovaCart website or app and trusted payment interfaces when making payments.

If a customer suspects unauthorized payment activity, the customer should contact the relevant bank or payment provider immediately and notify NovaCart support so that the order or account can be reviewed.

11. Payment Information Required for Support

To investigate a payment issue, support may request non-sensitive transaction information such as:

- Order number, if available.
- Transaction/reference ID.
- Payment date and approximate time.
- Payment amount.
- Payment method.
- Screenshot or receipt showing transaction status, where appropriate.

Customers should hide or avoid sharing sensitive credentials, full card numbers, PINs, passwords, and OTPs.

12. Payment-Related Ticket Creation

A normal question such as asking which payment methods NovaCart supports does not necessarily require a support ticket.

A ticket may be appropriate when the customer reports a transaction that requires investigation, such as:

- Payment deducted but order not confirmed.
- Payment charged more than once.
- Payment marked successful by the provider but not reflected in the order.
- A payment remains unresolved or pending.
- A customer disputes a payment outcome and automated support cannot resolve the issue.

The Autonomous Customer Support Copilot may classify the customer's intent and determine whether a ticket is required according to the support workflow.

13. Escalation Conditions

A payment issue should be escalated to human support when the AI assistant cannot confidently resolve the case using the approved knowledge base, when transaction verification is required, when a customer reports a potentially duplicate charge, when a payment is deducted without a confirmed order, or when the issue requires access to internal transaction records.

The AI assistant must not claim that a payment has been verified or refunded unless the relevant system or authorized support process has actually confirmed it.

14. Refund Relationship

Payment problems may result in a refund when a payment was successfully captured but the corresponding order cannot be fulfilled or confirmed, subject to NovaCart's Refund Policy.

The Payment Policy explains how payment issues are identified and investigated. The Refund Policy defines refund eligibility, processing stages, supported refund methods, and expected processing timelines.

15. Customer Support Guidance

When responding to a payment issue, support should:

- Identify the customer's payment-related intent.
- Determine whether an order exists and whether it is confirmed.
- Ask only for the non-sensitive information necessary for investigation.
- Avoid requesting passwords, PINs, OTPs, or confidential credentials.
- Provide clear next steps.
- Escalate cases requiring transaction verification or internal investigation.
- Avoid promising a refund or order confirmation before verification is completed.

16. Examples

Example 1 — General payment question:

Customer: "Which payment methods do you accept?"

Expected handling: Provide the supported payment methods. No ticket is normally required.

Example 2 — Payment deducted but no order:

Customer: "My payment was deducted but my order was not confirmed."

Expected handling: Classify as a payment issue, request appropriate transaction details, and create/escalate a ticket when investigation is required.

Example 3 — Duplicate charge:

Customer: "I was charged twice for the same order."

Expected handling: Request the order number and relevant transaction references, then route the case for payment verification.

Example 4 — Payment failed with no deduction:

Customer: "My card payment failed and I was not charged."

Expected handling: Explain that the customer may retry using an available payment method after checking the payment details.

17. Policy Authority

This document is the authoritative source for NovaCart's high-level payment handling rules within the project knowledge base. More specific documents may define additional rules for refunds, returns, cancellation, delivery, or account-related issues.

The customer-support AI should use retrieved company documentation rather than inventing payment rules. If the available documentation does not contain enough information to resolve a payment issue safely, the issue should be escalated to human support.

This document is fictional and created exclusively for the Autonomous Customer Support Copilot project.